



Chosen for Shade, Priced for Power

A discrete-choice experiment on caravan-park site selection, against the tariff schedule that prices the connection

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The problem

Holiday-park tariffs price what a site is connected to: power, water, an ensuite. The guest at the office window is choosing on something else. Which attributes actually move a booking, and can the schedule that prices sites represent them at all?

Research questions

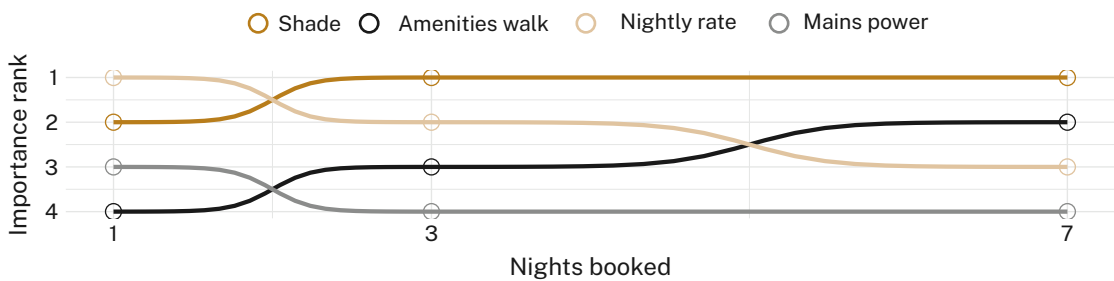
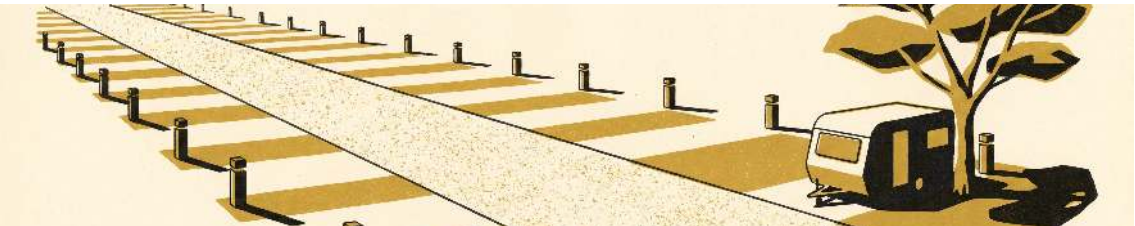
- Estimate part-worth utilities for the six site attributes bookers trade off
- Convert each to willingness to pay per night and set it against the posted loading
- Test whether attribute importance holds across stay length

Study design

- 612 recent bookers · 12 forced choices each · 7,344 choice tasks · 6 attributes · 9 parks · fielded over 14 weeks
- Mixed logit with correlated random coefficients; rate effects-coded and held orthogonal to the remaining five by design
- Attribute levels drawn from what the group's booking system already stores, plus shade and turning circle, which it does not; the design was locked before the tariff round opened

What we found

Shade leads at every stay length beyond a single night. Mains power, the schedule's largest single loading, ranks last for stays of three nights or more, and the walk to the amenities block overtakes nightly rate once a stay passes a week.



Attribute importance rank by stay length, from 7,344 choice tasks across nine parks, February to May 2026 (n = 612). Mains power, the largest single loading on the posted schedule, does not rise above third at any stay length.

What it means

A tariff can price only a field the system holds. Connections are fields; canopy is not. Shaded sites clear first through summer at the undifferentiated rate, and the review reads that occupancy as evidence the schedule is sound. The current round adds a site-quality loading, applied by connection tier, the only field available to apply it to.

Next: whether any park in the group records canopy at site level at all.

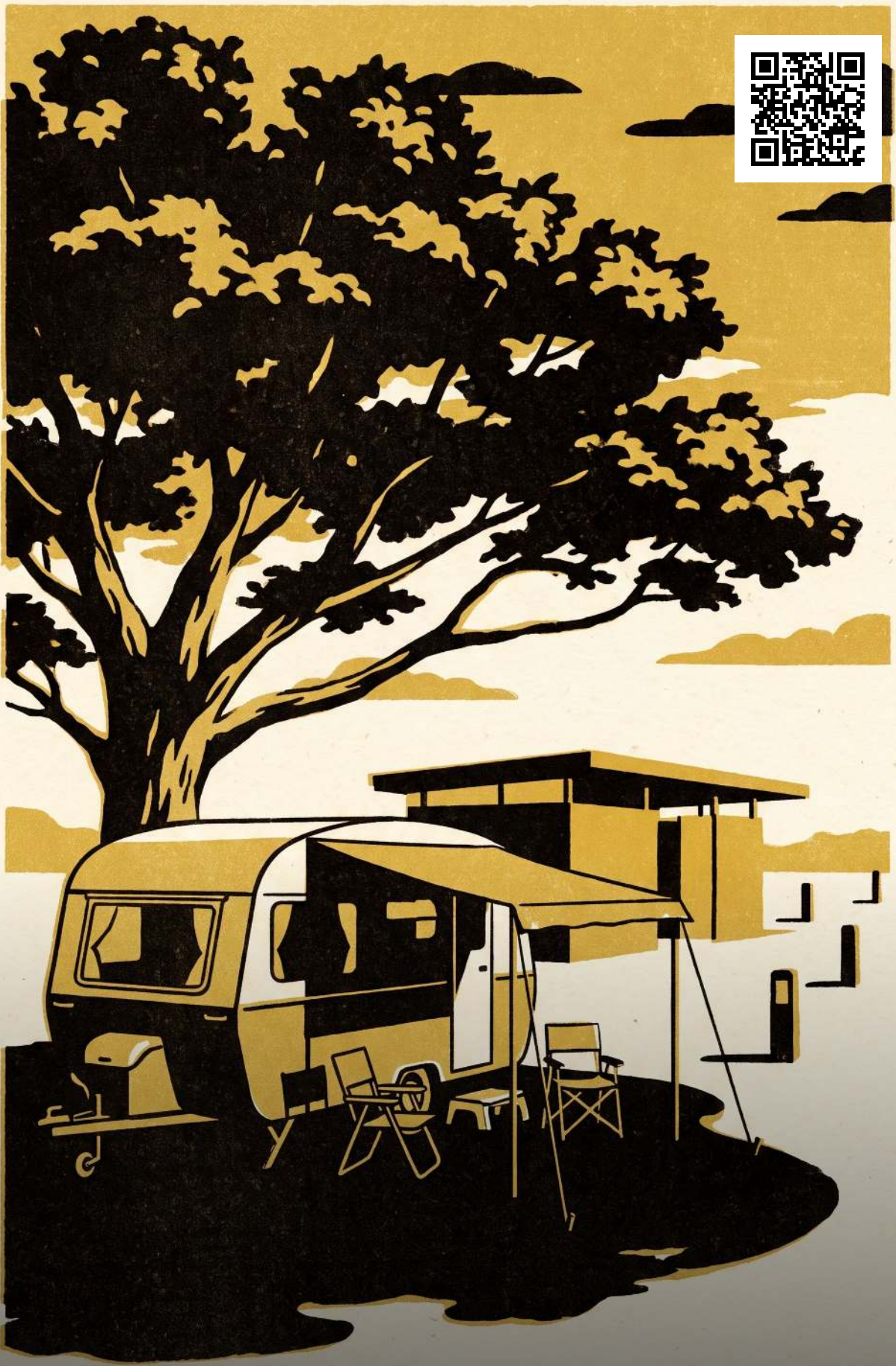
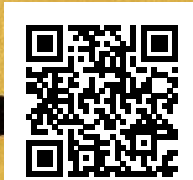
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Choice tasks carried no park or operator identifiers. Attribute list and utility specification lodged with the School before fieldwork opened; neither was amended.

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“Guests will pay three times more for the tree than for the power outlet.”

Willingness to pay per night: \$16.40 for a shaded site against \$5.20 for mains power. The posted schedule loads \$14.00 for the connection and holds no field for the tree.